Fact Sheet: Drawing Paper

Layout Paper

Layout Paper is a lightweight, semi-transparent and smooth paper.
Its most common use for sketching and planning initial ideas.
It is not appropriate to use markers on it as it will bleed through.
Made by pulping wood and other fibres into a slurry where it is then dewatered, pressed and then dried.
The pulp is then bleached so it turns white and then pressed and dried again.

Tracing Paper

Tracing Paper is a translucent paper.
It is used by designers to copy or transfer an image / design.
It is used for tracing as it is translucent enough to let light go through, meaning the user can see the image underneath.
Tracing Paper has the same production process as layout paper but is more heavily treated so it is transparent.

Copier Paper

Copier Paper is a paper designed to be used in printers.
The paper itself is designed to be opaque so that it is possible to be written on both sides.
This means it is perfect to print pictures on both sides as they will not show.
Copier paper has the same production process as layout paper, but it is not refined making it opaque.

Cartridge Paper

Cartridge Paper is a strong, thick drawing paper traditionally used to make paper cartridges for firearms.
In designing it is used for drawing and sketching as it is durable and textured surface captures ink
Cartridge paper has the same production process as copier paper however it is not finished off with a smooth surface like all the other papers.